Here is your ultimate, complete master guide and brochure for the **2027 ICC Men's Cricket World Cup** 🏆. Everything from team qualification down to the final match is broken down step-by-step with zero confusion! 🏷️

🌍 How 14 Teams Become 12 for the Group Stage

A total of **14 teams** enter the broader World Cup cycle, but only **12 teams** play in the main Group Stage (6 + 6 = 12). Here is how that math works:

1. **10 Direct Qualifiers:** South Africa 🇿🇦 and Zimbabwe 🇿🇼 get automatic entry as co-hosts. The next 8 top-ranked teams on the ICC ODI rankings also qualify directly (India 🇮🇳, Australia 🇦🇺, England 🏴, New Zealand 🇳🇿, Sri Lanka 🇱🇰, Pakistan 🇵🇰, Bangladesh 🇧🇩, and Afghanistan 🇦🇫).
2. **The 4 Global Qualifier Teams:** A separate qualifying tournament decides the last 4 spots:
    - The **#1 winner** of that qualifier gets a direct VIP ticket into Group A as **"Qualifier A"**.
    - The **#2, #3, and #4 teams** from that qualifier must play a mini-playoff tournament in Namibia called the **Super Series**.
    - Out of those 3 teams, **only 1 winner** advances to Group B as **"Qualifier B"**, while the other 2 teams are eliminated and sent home!
    - *Total for Group Stage:* 10 Direct + Qualifier A + Qualifier B = **12 Teams**.

🎟️ Phase 1: The Super Series (Namibia Play-offs)

- **What happens:** The 3 runner-up teams from the global qualifiers play a mini round-robin in Windhoek, Namibia, to decide the final World Cup group spot (**Qualifier B**).
- **Schedule & Venues:**

Date 📅	Match ⚔️	Venue 🏟️
Sat, 2 Oct 2027	Qualifier Team 1 vs Qualifier Team 3	Windhoek, Namibia 🇳🇦
Mon, 4 Oct 2027	Qualifier Team 1 vs Qualifier Team 2	Windhoek, Namibia 🇳🇦
Wed, 6 Oct 2027	Qualifier Team 2 vs Qualifier Team 3	Windhoek, Namibia 🇳🇦

📊 Phase 2: The Group Stage

- **What happens:** The 12 teams split into two groups of 6. Every team plays 5 matches against everyone in their group.
    - **Group A:** India 🇮🇳, Australia 🇦🇺, Pakistan 🇵🇰, Afghanistan 🇦🇫, Zimbabwe 🇿🇼, Qualifier A.
    - **Group B:** South Africa 🇿🇦, New Zealand 🇳🇿, England 🏴Sri Lanka 🇱🇰, Bangladesh 🇧🇩, Qualifier B.
- **The Rule:** The **top 3 teams** from Group A and the **top 3 teams** from Group B advance, alongside the **best 4th-placed team** overall. That makes **7 teams** moving forward to the next phase.
- **Schedule & Venues:**

Date 🗓️	Match ⚔️	Venue 🏟️
Thu, 7 Oct 2027	India vs Australia	Cape Town, South Africa 🇿🇦
Fri, 8 Oct 2027	Pakistan vs Afghanistan	Tshwane, South Africa 🇿🇦
Fri, 8 Oct 2027	England vs Bangladesh	Windhoek, Namibia 🇳🇦
Sat, 9 Oct 2027	Zimbabwe vs Qualifier A	Bulawayo, Zimbabwe 🇿🇼
Sat, 9 Oct 2027	South Africa vs New Zealand	Cape Town, South Africa 🇿🇦
Sun, 10 Oct 2027	India vs Pakistan	Johannesburg, South Africa 🇿🇦
Sun, 10 Oct 2027	Sri Lanka vs Qualifier B	Windhoek, Namibia 🇳🇦
Mon, 11 Oct 2027	Zimbabwe vs Afghanistan	Bulawayo, Zimbabwe 🇿🇼
Tue, 12 Oct 2027	Australia vs Qualifier A	Paarl, South Africa 🇿🇦
Tue, 12 Oct 2027	New Zealand vs Bangladesh	KuGompo City, South Africa 🇿🇦
Wed, 13 Oct 2027	England vs Sri Lanka	Windhoek, Namibia 🇳🇦
Wed, 13 Oct 2027	South Africa vs Qualifier B	Paarl, South Africa 🇿🇦
Thu, 14 Oct 2027	India vs Afghanistan	Tshwane, South Africa 🇿🇦
Fri, 15 Oct 2027	Pakistan vs Qualifier A	Bloemfontein, South Africa 🇿🇦

Fri, 15 Oct 2027	Zimbabwe vs Australia	Harare, Zimbabwe □□
Sat, 16 Oct 2027	Sri Lanka vs Bangladesh	Durban, South Africa □□
Sat, 16 Oct 2027	South Africa vs England	Gqeberha, South Africa □□
Sun, 17 Oct 2027	India vs Qualifier A	Bloemfontein, South Africa □□
Sun, 17 Oct 2027	New Zealand vs Qualifier B	Harare, Zimbabwe □□
Mon, 18 Oct 2027	Australia vs Afghanistan	KuGompo City, South Africa □□
Tue, 19 Oct 2027	Zimbabwe vs Pakistan	Harare, Zimbabwe □□
Tue, 19 Oct 2027	South Africa vs Bangladesh	Durban, South Africa □□
Wed, 20 Oct 2027	New Zealand vs Sri Lanka	Johannesburg, South Africa □□
Wed, 20 Oct 2027	England vs Qualifier B	Harare, Zimbabwe □□
Thu, 21 Oct 2027	Afghanistan vs Qualifier A	KuGompo City, South Africa □□
Fri, 22 Oct 2027	Australia vs Pakistan	Paarl, South Africa □□
Fri, 22 Oct 2027	South Africa vs Sri Lanka	Johannesburg, South Africa □□
Sat, 23 Oct 2027	England vs New Zealand	Gqeberha, South Africa □□
Sat, 23 Oct 2027	Bangladesh vs Qualifier B	Tshwane, South Africa □□
Sun, 24 Oct 2027	Zimbabwe vs India	Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe □□

🌪️ Phase 3: The Super 7 Stage

- **What happens:** The 7 surviving teams form a single group. **All previous group-stage points are completely wiped to zero!** Every team starts fresh.
- **The Format:** For scheduling and tracking, teams take positional codes based on group standing—Group A top 3 (**A1, A2, A3**), Group B top 3 (**B1, B2, B3**), and the best 4th-place team (**AB4**). Teams play matches against the

opponents they haven't met yet. The **top 4 teams** on the table advance to the semi-finals.

- **Schedule & Venues:**

Date □	Super 7 Matchup (Positional Codes) ⚔	Venue 🏟
Mon, 25 Oct 2027	A2 vs B3	Johannesburg, South Africa □□
Tue, 26 Oct 2027	B1 vs A3	Gqeberha, South Africa □□
Wed, 27 Oct 2027	B2 vs AB4	Tshwane, South Africa □□
Thu, 28 Oct 2027	A1 vs A2	Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe □□
Fri, 29 Oct 2027	B1 vs B3	KuGompo City, South Africa □□
Sat, 30 Oct 2027	A3 vs AB4	Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe □□
Sun, 31 Oct 2027	B2 vs A1	Johannesburg, South Africa □□
Mon, 1 Nov 2027	A2 vs B1	Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe □□
Tue, 2 Nov 2027	B3 vs AB4	Cape Town, South Africa □□
Wed, 3 Nov 2027	B2 vs A3	Durban, South Africa □□
Thu, 4 Nov 2027	A1 vs B1	Paarl, South Africa □□
Fri, 5 Nov 2027	A2 vs AB4	Durban, South Africa □□
Sat, 6 Nov 2027	B2 vs B3	Bloemfontein, South Africa □□
Sun, 7 Nov 2027	A1 vs A3	Cape Town, South Africa □□
Mon, 8 Nov 2027	B1 vs AB4	Durban, South Africa □□
Tue, 9 Nov 2027	B2 vs A2	Gqeberha, South Africa □□
Wed, 10 Nov	A3 vs B3	Bloemfontein, South Africa

2027		□□
Thu, 11 Nov 2027	A1 vs AB4	Gqeberha, South Africa □□
Fri, 12 Nov 2027	B2 vs B1	Cape Town, South Africa □□
Sat, 13 Nov 2027	A2 vs A3	Bloemfontein, South Africa □□
Sun, 14 Nov 2027	A1 vs B3	Durban, South Africa □□

□ Phase 4: Knockouts & The Grand Final

- **What happens:** Sudden-death elimination matches. Win and move forward; lose and you are out!
- **Schedule & Venues:**

Date □	Match Stage ⚔	Pairing Rule 📋	Venue 🏟
Wed, 17 Nov 2027	**Semi-Final 1**	1st Place vs 4th Place	Cape Town, South Africa □□
Thu, 18 Nov 2027	**Semi-Final 2**	2nd Place vs 3rd Place	Tshwane, South Africa □□
Sun, 21 Nov 2027	**The Grand Final** □	Winner SF1 vs Winner SF2	Johannesburg, South Africa □□

🏆 Final Simulation & Conclusion

- **Semi-Final Results:** India □□ wins Semi-Final 1, and Australia □□ wins Semi-Final 2.
- **The Grand Final:** In an epic heavyweight rematch of the 2023 World Cup final, **India □□ plays Australia □□** in Johannesburg.
- **The Historic Milestone:** During the summit clash, **Virat Kohli bats masterfully to score his historic 100th international century □□**!
- **The Result:** India posts a massive total, restricts the Australian batting lineup, and **India wins the match to lift the 2027 Cricket World Cup trophy!** 🏆